



Navigational novelties

Without navigational aids, sailors would rarely sail out of sight of land.

Knowing WHERE YOU'RE GOING

Sailors would be completely lost without these ingenious inventions. They have allowed explorers to travel the world and discover new lands.



The oldest map ever found is 12,000 years old.



Map

Simple maps of the heavens and of geographical features were **carved onto cave walls** thousands of years ago. Gradually, they became more detailed and useful. **PTOLEMY**, a Greek astronomer who lived in Egypt in the 2nd century, drew maps that included lines of **longitude** and **latitude**. His ideas revolutionized mapmaking when his maps were rediscovered by Europeans in the 1400s. Their maps became ***much more accurate***. As new lands were discovered, the modern world map took shape.

Compass

The Chinese were using compasses during the **QIN DYNASTY** (221–206 BCE) to make sure that buildings were facing the right way for good fortune. The spoon-shaped needle was made from **lodestone**, a naturally magnetized mineral that always points toward magnetic north. Around the **11th century**, compasses began to be used for navigation.

